

Ubayd Hattas

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

First-year Computer Science, Statistics & Data Science student at the University of Cape Town who builds and ships production software rather than just studying it. Creator of **AfriGuard**, a multilingual AI safety benchmark that red-teamed four frontier LLMs across seven South African languages (1,120 model evaluations), and **SA Data Hub**, a live public data platform making South African statistics accessible to students and journalists. Full-stack experience with Next.js, React, TypeScript, PostgreSQL and Python, with a growing interest in AI safety, data engineering and technical writing.

EDUCATION

University of Cape Town (UCT)

Bachelor of Science: Computer Science, Statistics & Data Science

Cape Town, South Africa

Expected Graduation: 2028

Trafalgar High School

National Senior Certificate (NSC)

Cape Town, South Africa

2025

- Top 5 academic ranking in the matric class
- Top NSC Mathematics learner
- Top NSC Physical Sciences learner
- Awarded 1st Place in Grade 11 Physical Sciences (2024)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL

Frameworks & Tools: Next.js, React, Tailwind CSS, Node.js, Streamlit, Git/GitHub, Vercel, VS Code

Databases: PostgreSQL

Data & AI: Pandas, ETL Pipelines, Data Visualisation (Recharts), AI Safety, LLM Evaluation & Prompt Engineering, Benchmark Design, REST APIs

PROJECTS

[AfriGuard: Multilingual AI Safety Benchmark](#)

Global South AI Safety Hackathon, Cape Town

[GitHub](#) [Live Demo](#)

- Built a benchmark testing whether frontier LLM safety guardrails hold up in South African languages, red-teaming 4 models (GPT-OSS, Llama 3.3, Kimi K2.6, Qwen 3) across 7 language conditions (6 African languages + English baseline)
- Designed 40 seed prompts across four regionally relevant harm categories (SASSA-grant fraud, xenophobic incitement, political disinformation, gang facilitation), producing 280 benchmark prompts and 1,120 total model evaluations
- Found a mean Attack Success Rate of 50.1% across all evaluations vs. 24.4% for English, with some model-language pairs exceeding 90% ASR, demonstrating that safety alignment degrades sharply outside English
- Built an automated LLM-judging pipeline and an interactive Streamlit dashboard for exploring results across languages and harm categories; shipped over a single hackathon weekend

[SA Data Hub: Public Data Platform](#)

Deployed & Actively Maintained

[GitHub](#) [Live Demo](#)

- Developed and actively maintain a public platform that makes South African statistics accessible through interactive dashboards, province comparisons and long-form data insights, built using official datasets from Statistics South Africa, the South African Reserve Bank and other public institutions
- Built the full-stack application with Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS and Recharts
- Currently expanding the platform with PostgreSQL integration, automated ETL pipelines and data validation infrastructure
- Implemented transparency features including per dataset source links, methodology documentation and full text search across datasets

[Personal Website & Technical Blog](#)

ubayd.me

- Designed and deployed a personal portfolio site (Next.js, React, Tailwind CSS) with responsive multi-page routing and SEO, showcasing software engineering projects, technical writing and research in public data and AI safety

TECHNICAL WRITING

- Publish technical articles through my personal website covering software engineering, public data and AI safety
- Document architecture, implementation decisions and engineering workflows for my projects

LEADERSHIP & ACHIEVEMENTS

Head Boy

2025

- Elected Head Boy, representing the student body and working closely with school leadership
- Helped organise school events, assemblies and student initiatives
- Tutored junior Mathematics learners during school breaks